

unit 1

ا

alif

ا

'a' in father when long

unit 1

ب

be

ب ب ب

'b' in bat

unit 1

ک

kāf

ک ک ک

'k' in kite

unit 1

ل

lām

ل ل ل

'l' in log

unit 1

م

mīm

م م م

'm' in mat

unit 1

ن

nūn

ن ن ن

'n' in net

unit 2

ت

te

ت ت ت

soft dental 't', tongue on the teeth  
(Spanish 'tú')

unit 2

ی

choī ye

ی ی ی

'y' in yes at the start

unit 2

ے

baṛī ye

ے

'ay' in day

unit 3

پ

pe

پ پ پ

'p' in pat

unit 3

ٹ

ṭe

ٹ ٹ ٹ

hard English 't' in tap, tongue curled  
back

unit 3

ث

se

ث ث ث

's' in sun (Arabic loanwords only)

unit 4

و

wā' o

و

'w'/'v' at the start

unit 4

ر

re

ر

tapped 'r' (Spanish 'pero')

unit 4

د

dāl

د

soft dental 'd', tongue on the teeth

unit 4

ه

choī he (gol he)

ه ه ه

'h' in hat

unit 5

س

sīn

س س س

's' in sun

unit 5

ش

shīn

ش ش ش

'sh' in shop

unit 5

ج

jīm

ج ج ج

'j' in jam

unit 5

چ

che

چ چ چ

'ch' in chair

unit 5

گ

gāf

گ گ گ

'g' in go

unit 6

ں

nūn ghunna

ں

nasalises the vowel before it, like  
French 'bon'

unit 6

ھ

do-chashmī he

ھ ھ ھ

a puff of breath after the letter before  
it: ھ bh, ھ ph, ھ kh, ھ gh...

unit 7

ڈ

dāl

ڈ

hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled  
back

unit 7

ڑ

re

ڑ

a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)

unit 7

ز

ze

ز

'z' in zoo

unit 7

ژ

zhe

ژ

's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)

unit 8

ف

fe

ف ف ف

'f' in fat

unit 8

ق

qāf

ق ق ق

a 'k' made far back in the throat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 8

خ

khe

خ خ خ

'ch' in Scottish loch

unit 8

غ

ghain

غ غ غ

a gargled 'g', like the French 'r'

unit 8

ع

'ain

ع ع ع

in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel written around it (عمر umar)

unit 8

ح

barī ḥe

ح ح ح

'h' in hat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 9

ص

ṣwād

ص ص ص

's' in sun

unit 9

ض

ẓwād

ض ض ض

'z' in zoo

unit 9

ط

ṭo'e

ط ط ط

soft 't'

unit 9

ظ

zō'e

ظ ظ ظ

'z' in zoo

unit 9

ز

zāl

ز

'z' in zoo

unit 10

ء

hamza

ء ء ء

a tiny break between two vowels (کوئی  
ko-ī). It rides on ی as ئ, on و as ؤ, or  
stands alone...